analysis of its inclusion, let alone comparing our own border controls and networks of divided power.

In addition, video montages and interpretations of historical time lines—especially those used in television commercials for Pepsi and Johnnie Walker, among others; aired during key sporting events, such as the Super Bowl or the World Cup; or placed in museums such as the Smithsonian Institution in Washington, D.C., or the Constitution Center in Philadelphia—often include footage of the Berlin Wall's dismantling to illustrate one sequence in a flow of events that embody a milestone or endpoint to celebrate the progress of U.S. "history." In such productions, the taking down of the Wall slips into the narrative alongside critical markers in American history. Such representations seem to be stuck in a feedback loop that favors the experience of elation rather than historical reflection, a fantasy of freedom that smooths out complication. As Joshua Clover notes, "It is impossible to ignore the extent to which the Berlin Wall's deconstruction, as captured in photos, broadcasts, videos, news reports, and the rest, provides a concrete image of unification as an achieved condition, of the overcoming of contradiction and discontinuity."[18] In mainstream venues, the Berlin Wall slips in and out of perception and in and out of an Americanized, imagined geography.

Beyond the hundreds of references to the Wall in popular and political culture while it was standing, again, one can look to the dozens of pieces of the former Wall that have been placed in dozens of monumental contexts and public spaces across the United States since reunification as proof of this long-standing incorporation. Such remnants—whether they are installed in the galleries of the Smithsonian Institution in Washington, D.C.; along Wilshire Boulevard in Los Angeles; across numerous presidential libraries and college campuses; on a public plaza adjacent to Ground Zero in lower Manhattan; or at the National Underground Railroad Freedom Center along the Ohio River, which once represented the demarcation line between free and enslaving states—speak to America's deep bonds with Berlin. In some instances, the Wall fragments celebrate state-sponsored diplomatic relationships between the United States and reunified Germany; in others, they are self-evident "pieces of history" to reflect narratives of U.S. power and progress; and finally, in rarer cases, their placement refers to the layers and legacies of domestic division as inscribed into our public spaces during this same period.[19] To gain a fuller understanding of the